- *It handles dependencies.* Ever tried to register a web server with a load balancer that wasn't yet available? When you first start trying to automate infrastructure creation, you'll miss a lot of dependencies. Trust us: never try to set up complex infrastructure using scripts. You'll end up in dependency hell!
- *It's reproducible.* Is your test environment an exact copy of your production environment? Using CloudFormation, you can create two identical infrastructures. It is also possible to apply changes to both the test and production environment.
- *It's customizable.* You can insert custom parameters into CloudFormation to customize your templates as you wish.
- *It's testable.* If you can create your architecture from a template, it's testable. Just start a new infrastructure, run your tests, and shut it down again.
- *It's updatable.* CloudFormation supports updates to your infrastructure. It will figure out the parts of the template that have changed and apply those changes as smoothly as possible to your infrastructure.
- *It minimizes human failure.* CloudFormation doesn't get tired—even at 3 a.m.
- *It's the documentation for your infrastructure.* A CloudFormation template is a JSON or YAML document. You can treat it as code and use a version control system like Git to keep track of the changes.
- *It's free.* Using CloudFormation comes at no additional charge. If you subscribe to an AWS support plan, you also get support for CloudFormation.

We think CloudFormation is the most powerful tool available for managing infrastructure on AWS.